



# Bazaar

A speaker system, an MP3 player, an optical keyboard and mouse, a tool for creating Flash effects, a data recovery utility and more...



## Logitech Cordless Freedom

As good as it gets

This Logitech Freedom optical keyboard and mouse is a whole standard apart from your typical mouse and keyboard combo. It consists of a wireless keyboard and an optical mouse. The keyboard sports 'space age' looks and is very comfortable to use. The layout of the shortcut keys is just right and they are easily accessible. The other buttons are well laid out too and they have a great feel to them. Using the bundled iTouch software, the keyboard can be easily configured for all the extra shortcut keys. The packaging of the product is excellent and comes bundled with the manuals, driver CDs, MouseWare and the iTouch software, spare batteries and the receiver. The keyboard and mouse communicate through radio waves and work surprisingly well even beyond the specified range of 6 feet. The optical mouse has a resolution of 800 dpi and

uses no moving parts, which means there's no cleaning required. The provided scroll wheel feels handy while browsing the Net. The mouse buttons can be configured easily through the MouseWare software. If you want an 'ordinary' keyboard-mouse combination then this set is definitely not the one for you. It requires 4 AA batteries for the keyboard and 2 AA batteries for the mouse and the average battery life span that we have generally observed for devices such as these is around four months. Priced at Rs 8,000, it is clearly the most expensive combination of input devices that you can buy.

**SPECIFICATIONS:**  
Infrared mouse included; many functions such as browser launch; iTouch software to configure keys for various applications; in-built clickable wheel on the keyboard

| Logitech Cordless |                     | A- |
|-------------------|---------------------|----|
| Ease of use       | ★★★★                |    |
| Build Quality     | ★★★★                |    |
| Value for Money   | ★★★★ <sup>1/2</sup> |    |
| Features          | ★★★★                |    |
| OVERALL           | ★★★★                |    |

Price: Rs 8,000  
Contact: Rashi Peripherals  
Phone: 022-8260258  
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com  
Web site: www.rptechindia.com

## AOpen DVD-1648

Driven performer

This 16x DVD drive from AOpen comes with Dynamic Damping System, which helps in nullifying the vibration that is generally present in high-speed drives. The drive has excellent build quality and comes bundled with the Cyberlink PowerDVD 3.0 software DVD player. It performed very well in the test suite—it never skipped a frame and played the DVD impeccably. We tested the drive for DAE performance wherein it extracted a 50 MB track within 31 seconds, proving itself to be quite a force to reckon with. However, it took more time than similar speed DVD drives when subjected to the file transfer test. Opening 10 TIFF images from the drive in Photoshop took around 71.65 seconds—slightly on the higher side. The access time logged



was 64 ms, which is really low. Though this is certainly not the fastest speed of access that you can get, this drive will serve the purpose well, if you want to have only one drive for all purposes—CD as well as DVD. This AOpen drive costs as less as Rs 4,500. When you couple the price with the drive's decent performance, you have a really affordable DVD drive on your hands.

**SPECIFICATIONS:**  
16x DVD speed, 48x CD speed, 256 KB buffer, DDS (Dynamic Damping System)  
**Benchmarks:** 2030 in CD Winbench 99; 64 ms random access time in SiSoft Sandra 2001te; 33 seconds to rip the outermost track which was 61.26 MB in size

| Aopen DVD-1648  |                     | B+ |
|-----------------|---------------------|----|
| Performance     | ★★★★ <sup>1/2</sup> |    |
| Build Quality   | ★★★★                |    |
| Value for Money | ★★★★                |    |
| Features        | ★★★★ <sup>1/2</sup> |    |
| OVERALL         | ★★★★ <sup>1/2</sup> |    |

Price: Rs 4,500  
Contact: Yogi Comp  
Phone: 022-8806582  
E-mail: yogicomp@netracker.com

## Canon CanoScan N1240

Smart scanner

The Canon CanoScan is just a little over an inch thick. This scanner can even be kept vertical on the saddle that comes along with it while scanning documents. This will prove especially useful if you have limited desk space. The scanner comes



with Adobe Photoshop Element, ArcSoft PhotoBase, and ScanSoft OmniPage OCR software. Its preview time was logged at 19 seconds, which is a little on the higher side due to the initial warm up time taken by the scanner. But